

Slides 5.2: What Clothing Communicates

Slide outline for Lesson 5.2, one day, thirteen slides. The plain shirt on a hanger carries slides 5 to 7; the chart paper carries slides 10 to 12.

Slide 1: What clothing says before you do

- Lesson 5.2
- One rule today: we talk about clothing, not about each other's clothes
- Nobody in this room has to explain or defend what they are wearing
- By the end: this class writes an agreement we all sign Image: a speech bubble with a T-shirt shape inside it instead of words. Notes: Say the rule out loud and point at it on the board. It is already written up there from before the bell.

Slide 2: Do now

- Two people walk into a store
- One is wearing a suit. One is wearing a delivery uniform.
- Write the first thing you assume about each one
- Then write one reason your assumption could be wrong Image: two plain figures side by side, one in a suit, one in a delivery uniform with a package.

Slide 3: Four channels of communication

1. Words: what you choose to say
 2. Voice: tone, volume, speed, pauses
 3. Body: face, hands, posture, distance
 4. Appearance: clothing, grooming, what you carry
- Clothing lives in channel 4, and people read it first Image: four labeled boxes in a row with an eye icon over box 4. Notes: People form an impression almost instantly, before you speak.

Slide 4: Nonverbal means without words

- Nobody chose to send the message
- The message got sent anyway
- Knowing that gives you a choice: you can dress on purpose
- It does not give you the right to grade what anybody else is wearing Image: a mouth with an X over it next to a shirt with sound lines coming off it.

Slide 5: What a uniform says

- "I have a role here"
- It tells you what somebody does and who to ask for help
- It takes personal choice off the table on purpose
- A nurse, a referee, a team, a school with uniforms Image: three uniformed silhouettes with no faces, a nurse in scrubs, a referee in stripes, a player in a numbered jersey.

Notes: Ask what a police uniform says, then a referee's, then a school uniform. Three different answers, all loud.

Slide 6: What a costume says

- "This is not me today"
- On purpose, temporary, and both sides know it
- A play, a mascot, Spirit Week
- The trap: a costume only works when everybody knows it is a costume Image: a theater mask and a mascot head side by side.

Slide 7: One shirt, three settings

- Setting 1: a job interview
- Setting 2: a family cookout
- Setting 3: a school hallway
- Same shirt. Three readings. Image: the same plain button-down shown three ways, with a tie, sleeves rolled and untucked, and under a hoodie. Notes: Hold the actual shirt. Change it in front of them. For each setting ask: what does it say here, who is the audience, would it work in one of the others?

Slide 8: The shirt did not change

- What changed was the setting
- And the audience
- And what that audience already expects
- Write the sentence: "The shirt did not change. What changed was ____." Image: an arrow labeled "setting" and an arrow labeled "audience" both pointing at one unchanged shirt.

Slide 9: Clothing and culture

- A hijab, a sari, a kilt, a kente cloth, a guayabera, a kufi, a huipil
- Religious, regional, practical, and often very old
- An item that belongs to a living culture is not a costume
- "It is just a costume" is not an answer Image: seven small respectful illustrations of the named garments, each labeled, shown as garments and not on caricatured figures. Notes: Accuracy matters here. Name each item correctly. If a student in the room wears one of these, do not turn to them; the point is made from the slide.

Slide 10: Clothing and generations

- Jeans in the 1970s, the 1990s, and now
- Every generation thought theirs looked right
- Every generation got criticized by the one before it
- Every single one of them thought the criticism was unfair Image: three pairs of jeans in three silhouettes, wide, baggy, and current, labeled by decade. Notes: This is where the 80s Day story goes.

Slide 11: The sticky notes

- One comment about clothing you have heard at this school
- No names. No details that identify anybody.
- Face down in the box
- I read a few out loud. I skip anything with a name in it. Image: a small box with folded sticky notes going into a slot. Notes: Skim them before you read any aloud. Skip anything about a staff member.

Slide 12: We write the agreement

- Two columns: okay to say, not okay to say
- Nominate a line. I will ask you why.
- About five lines per column, so it can be read from the back
- Then we vote, and everybody who agrees signs it Image: a blank two-column chart with the headings “Okay to say” and “Not okay to say.” Notes: Push every nomination with “why?” Steer toward lines students can actually keep.

Slide 13: This stays up

- The agreement stays posted for the rest of Unit 5
- It comes back out on the first sewing day, when you hold up your own crooked first stitch
- And at the gallery walk, when thirty projects go on a table Image: the signed chart paper taped to a classroom wall next to a display table. Notes: Exit card: one line you will actually use; one thing clothing says without words; one question. Give the counselor a copy of the agreement.